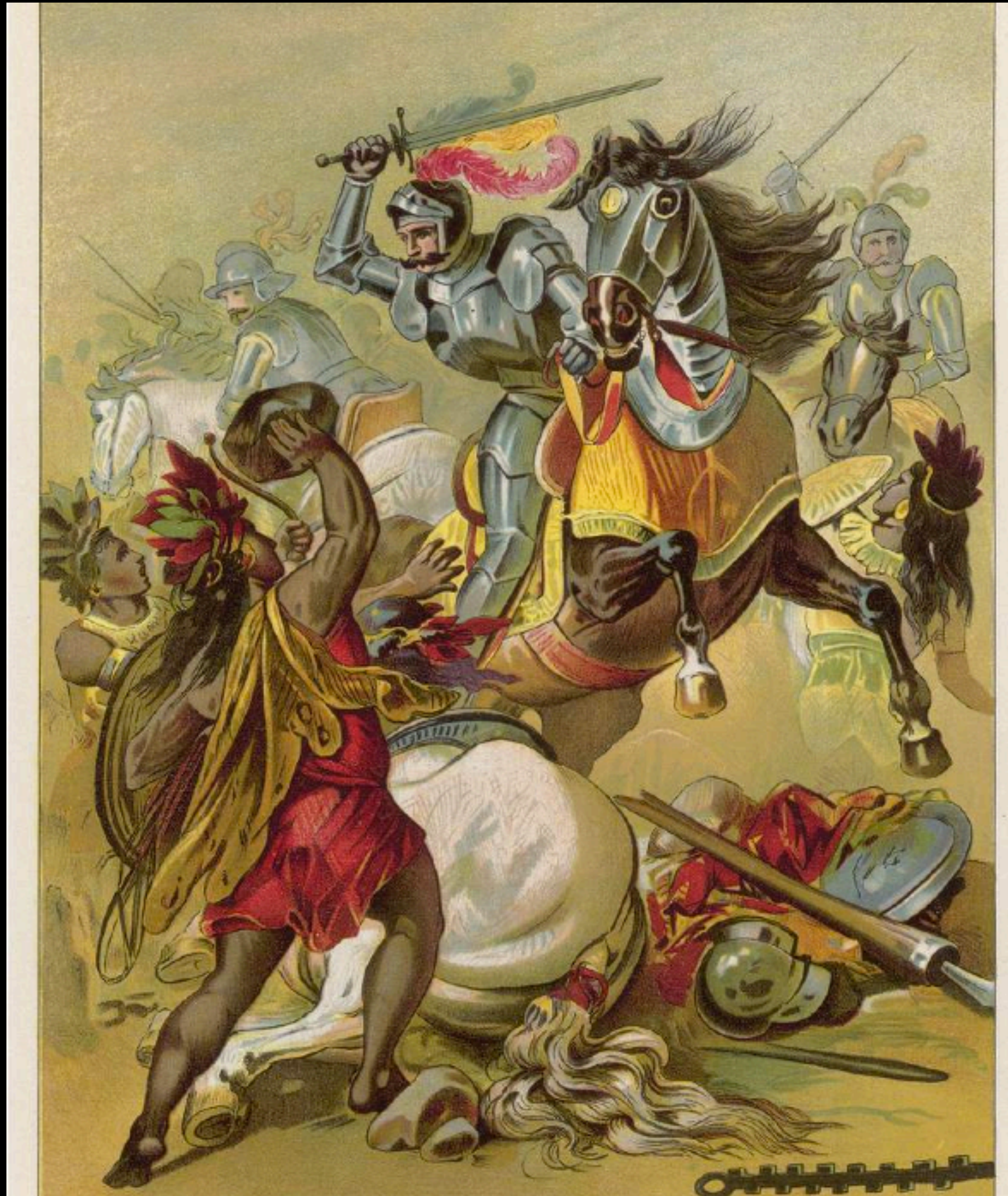
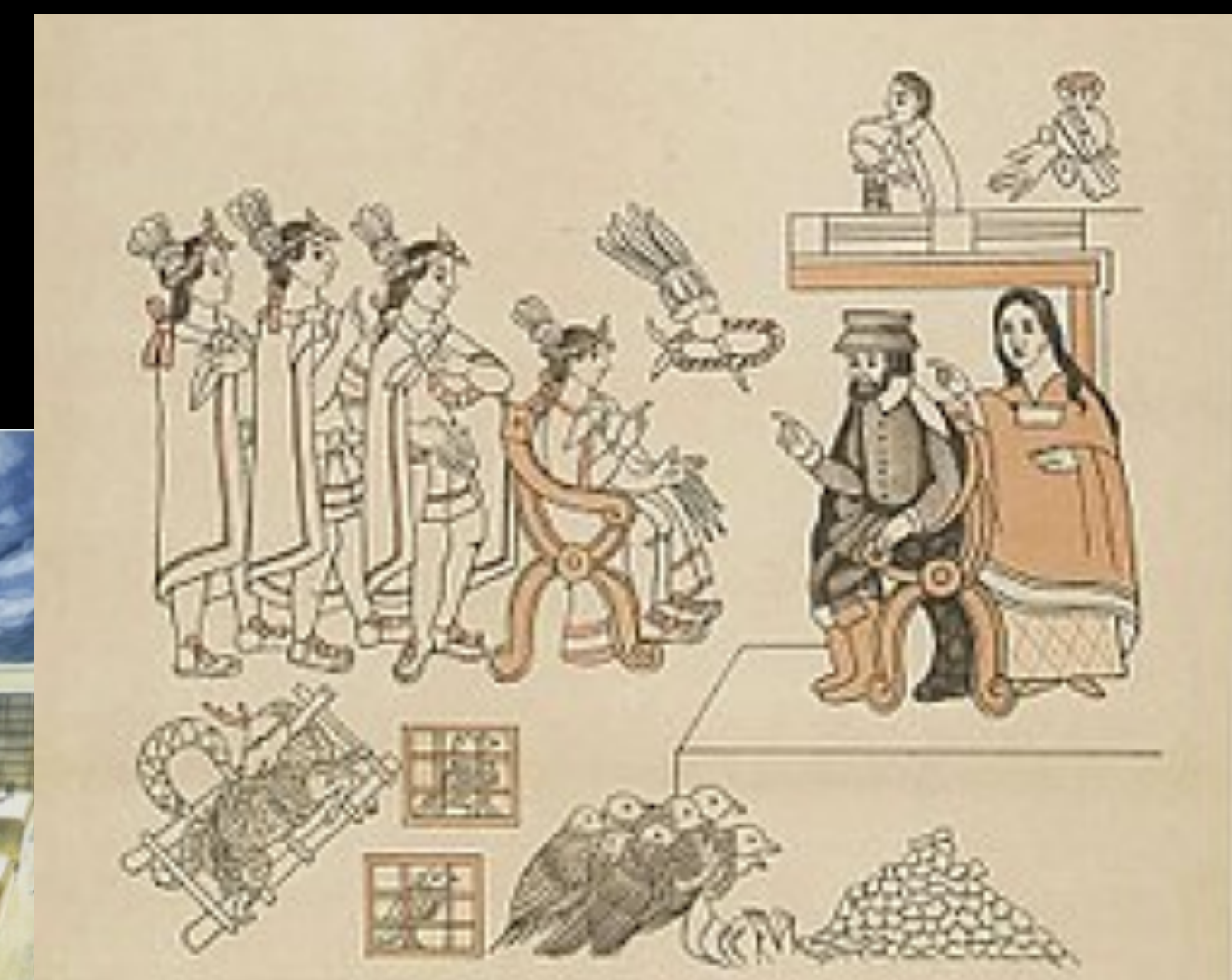


Conquistadors



- Poor nobles who were skilled warriors on horses, claimed lands using force
- Hernán Cortés & Francisco Pizarro



- Cortés received twenty young indigenous women from vanquished natives, and he converted them all to Christianity
- Made alliances with enemies of the Aztecs as he marched to the capital city of Tenochtitlan
- When he arrived, the Aztec ruler Moctezuma gave lavish gifts of gold to the Spaniards which, rather than placating them, excited their ambitions for plunder